

LITERACY COACH-APPROVED CHECKLIST

5 things to look for in a decodable text.

Swipe for the short version.

01

A clear phonics scope.

You should be able to tell, in under a minute, what skill the book is for. If a "decodable" book includes patterns kids haven't been taught, it isn't decodable for them.

02

Designed with a purpose in mind: instruction vs. fluency.

Decodables teaching a particular concept are different from decodables that review a variety of concepts. Kids need both, but they are different.

03

Content kids actually care about.

Engagement isn't a luxury. A bored reader is a slower reader. Content can be respectful of the phonics scope and still be interesting.

04

Built-in supports for you.

Warm-up word lists, blending lines, a quick lesson plan. The book should reduce prep, not add to it.

05

A reason to come back to it.

Decodables are not one-and-done. The best ones reward a second read with deeper comprehension or a new layer of fluency work.

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